

August 13, 2026

Absolute Total Care (Centene)  
Provider Appeals Department

**RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Stan Steuber (MRN MUSC2381078), Claim MUSC-2547-1**

|                          |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Patient</b>           | Stan Steuber (DOB 1969-05-08)                                                                               |
| <b>MRN</b>               | MUSC2381078                                                                                                 |
| <b>Member ID / Group</b> | ABS259528514 / GRP-55905                                                                                    |
| <b>Claim number</b>      | MUSC-2547-1                                                                                                 |
| <b>Date of service</b>   | 2026-05-05                                                                                                  |
| <b>Procedure billed</b>  | CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity                               |
| <b>Primary diagnosis</b> | E78.5 — Hyperlipidemia, unspecified                                                                         |
| <b>Denied amount</b>     | \$482.65                                                                                                    |
| <b>Denial code</b>       | CARC 204 / RARC N130 — This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan. |
| <b>Appeal deadline</b>   | 2026-08-26                                                                                                  |

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

**SUMMARY OF APPEAL**

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Stan Steuber (MRN: MUSC2381078, Member ID: ABS259528514) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-2547-1 for services rendered on May 5, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was denied by Absolute Total Care (Centene) under CARC 204 ("This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark stating: "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination and requests full reimbursement of the billed amount of \$482.65 for CPT code 99214.

**CLINICAL BACKGROUND**

Mr. Steuber is a 57-year-old male with an active diagnosis of hyperlipidemia (ICD-10 E78.5), documented as ongoing since December 2017. He has been maintained on simvastatin 10 mg, with the current active order placed at his January 2021 follow-up visit, at which time a total cholesterol of 206.17 mg/dL was recorded. His medical history also includes active obesity (ICD-10 E66.9, onset 2009), which is a recognized comorbidity relevant to cardiovascular risk management. The May 5, 2026 encounter, billed as a 99214 established outpatient visit of moderate complexity, was a follow-up visit for the ongoing management of his hyperlipidemia. The service was rendered by Dr. Sarah E. Whitmore, MD (NPI 1447382910) in an on-campus outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22), consistent with Mr. Steuber's established care pattern at MUSC Health.

## **BASIS FOR APPEAL**

The denial characterizing this evaluation and management service as a non-covered benefit is not consistent with standard Medicaid managed care coverage obligations. Outpatient office and clinic visits for the management of chronic conditions such as hyperlipidemia are among the most fundamental services covered under Medicaid benefit structures, and Absolute Total Care, as a Medicaid managed care organization operating under a state contract, is required to cover medically necessary outpatient services at a minimum. A routine follow-up visit for an active, chronic, and clinically significant condition does not constitute an excluded service under any standard Medicaid benefit framework.

Furthermore, CPT code 99214 was appropriately selected for this encounter. An established patient visit involving the ongoing management of active hyperlipidemia with a documented medication regimen and relevant comorbidities supports moderate medical decision-making, consistent with the requirements for this level of service under current CPT evaluation and management guidelines. The denial does not allege a coding error, and no clinical or coding rationale has been provided to support the exclusion finding beyond a general reference to the plan benefit document. MUSC Health requests that Absolute Total Care identify with specificity the benefit exclusion provision upon which this denial is based, as the payer's current explanation does not provide sufficient information to evaluate or rebut the stated basis for denial.

## **REQUESTED ACTION**

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Absolute Total Care (Centene) reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-2547-1 and issue payment at the allowed amount of \$296.53, or at the applicable contracted rate, for CPT 99214 rendered on May 5, 2026. Should the plan maintain that a specific benefit exclusion applies, MUSC Health requests that the plan provide the precise contractual or benefit document language supporting that determination so that a complete response may be submitted. This appeal is being submitted in advance of the August 26, 2026 appeal deadline, through the secure provider portal as directed on the Explanation of Payment.

Respectfully submitted,

**Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC**

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## **Enclosures**

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record